

SitholeFamilyRetail Store proposal

WEBSITE DEVELOPMENT

KHENSANI SITHOLE

ST10500261

1. Executive Summary

Sithole Family Retail requires a modern, user-centric website to expand its customer reach, showcase products, and increase online sales. Currently, the business lacks a cohesive digital presence, relying on word-of-mouth and walk-in customers. This proposal outlines the development of a responsive, secure, and scalable e-commerce website designed to serve as the central hub for Sithole Family Retail's operations, brand storytelling, and customer engagement.

2. Background & History

Sithole Family Retail was founded in **2010** in **Soweto, Johannesburg** by **Mr. and Mrs. Sithole**.

What began as a small spaza shop operating from their garage quickly grew into a beloved neighborhood retailer known for quality goods and personalized service. Recognizing the need for a reliable local supplier, the Sithole family expanded their offerings to include household essentials, fresh produce, and traditional African crafts. Over the last sixteen years, the

business has grown to serve thousands of loyal customers in the greater Johannesburg area. The **purpose** of Sithole Family Retail is to provide quality products with the warmth and trust of a family-owned business.

3. Mission & Vision Statements

- **Mission:** To provide our community with quality products and exceptional service, rooted in the values of family, trust, and integrity.
- **Vision:** To be the most trusted family-owned retailer in South Africa, bridging the gap between convenience and community.

4. Target Audience

Audience	Needs
Local Customers	Easy access to products, store hours, location, promotions
Online Shoppers	Secure online ordering, delivery options, product variety
Wholesale/Bulk Buyers	Bulk pricing inquiries, corporate gifting, partnership opportunities

5. Website Goals & Objectives (KPIs)

Goal	Objective	KPI
Increase Online Sales	Enable e-commerce functionality	30% of total revenue from online sales within 12 months
Expand Customer Reach	Attract customers beyond immediate locality	20% increase in new customer acquisitions within 6 months
Showcase Product Range	Display inventory in an organized, searchable manner	50% of users view at least 3 product pages per session
Build Brand Loyalty	Communicate family story and values	15% increase in repeat customers within 6 months

6. Current Website Analysis

- **No existing website** – business relies solely on walk-in traffic and WhatsApp orders
- **No online presence** – limited discoverability on search engines
- **Manual order management** – orders are tracked via pen and paper or messaging apps
- **No digital marketing** – unable to capture customer emails or run targeted promotions

7. Proposed Features & Functionality

Feature	Purpose
Online Store	Product catalog with categories, search, and filter functionality
Shopping Cart & Checkout	Secure payment gateway (PayFast, Yoco) with delivery options
Inventory Management	Real-time stock tracking to prevent overselling
Customer Accounts	Order history, saved addresses, wishlist functionality

Specials & Promotions	Display weekly deals, loyalty rewards, and seasonal offers
WhatsApp Integration	Click-to-chat for customer support and order inquiries
Store Locator	Map showing physical store location with hours and contact details
Bulk Inquiry Form	For wholesale customers and corporate gifting requests

8. Design Approach

- **Color Scheme:** Warm Earth Tones (Terracotta, Deep Orange) and Cream – reflecting heritage, warmth, and African identity
- **Layout:** Mobile-first, responsive design optimized for smartphones
- **Imagery:** High-quality product photography with authentic images of the Sithole family and store

9. Low-Fidelity Wireframe

```
text
+-----+
-----+
| [LOGO] Sithole Family Retail | Shop | About | Contact | [Cart] | [Search]
|
```

```
+-----+
|
|                                HERO SECTION
|
|    "Quality Goods, Family Values - Since 2010."
|
|    [Shop Now]                                [Weekly Specials →]
|
+-----+
|
|                                FEATURED CATEGORIES
|
|    [Household Essentials] [Fresh Produce] [Traditional Crafts] [Gifts]
|
+-----+
|
|                                WEEKLY SPECIALS
|
|    [Product 1 - 20% Off] [Product 2 - Buy 1 Get 1] [Product 3 - R50 Off]
|
|    [View All Specials →]
|
+-----+
|
|                                BESTSELLERS
|
|    [Product A] [Product B] [Product C] [Product D]
|
+-----+
|
|                                FAMILY STORY
|
|    "From a garage in Soweto to your neighborhood..." [Read Our Story →]
|
+-----+
|
|                                CUSTOMER TESTIMONIALS
|
|    "Best service in the area!" - Thabo M. | "Quality Products!" - Lerato K.
|
+-----+
|
```

NEWSLETTER

Get specials straight to your inbox.

[Email Input]

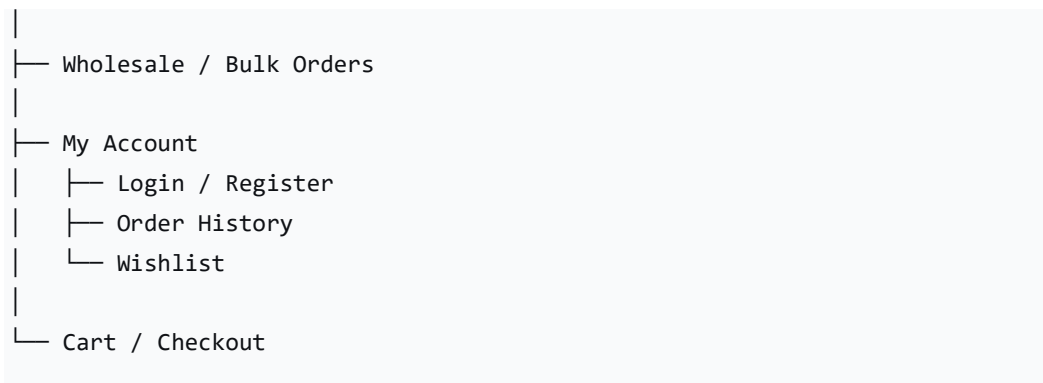
[Subscribe]

FOOTER

Store Hours | Location | Contact | WhatsApp | Delivery Info | Privacy Policy

10. Sitemap





11. Technical Requirements

Item	Specification
Domain	sitholefamilyretail.co.za (recommended)
Hosting	Managed WooCommerce hosting (secure, daily backups, scalable)
CMS	WordPress with WooCommerce
Payment Gateway	Pay Fast, Yoko, or PayPal integration
Security	SSL Certificate, PCI compliance for payment processing

12. Timeline & Milestones

Phase	Activity	Duration
Phase 1	Discovery & Product Catalog Setup	Week 1-2
Phase 2	Design (Wireframes, Mockups)	Week 3-4
Phase 3	Development (E-commerce setup, payment integration)	Week 5-8
Phase 4	Testing & QA (Payment testing, mobile testing)	Week 9
Phase 5	Training & Launch (Staff training on order management)	Week 10
Phase 6	Post-Launch Support	Week 11-14

Total Timeline: 3.5 Months

13. Budget

Item	Cost (ZAR)
------	------------

Strategy & UX	R 46,250
UI Design	R 64,750
E-Commerce Development	R 185,000
Product Catalog Setup	R 27,750
Payment Gateway Integration	R 18,500
QA & Training	R 18,500
Hosting & Domain (Year 1)	R 11,100
Total One-Time Setup	R 371,850
Annual Maintenance (Retainer)	R 44,400/year

14. Conclusion

A website for Sithole Family Retail is an investment in the future of the business. By establishing a professional online presence, the business will be able to reach new customers, increase sales, and continue serving the community with the same family values that have made it successful for sixteen years.

We look forward to partnering with the Sithole family to bring this vision to life.

